

Configuration Management and Version Control

Discussion 07 – CSC 4033

Readings

The reading selections represent four very different takes on Configuration Management (CM) and Version Control (VC). They're all wrong (or incomplete), which will make the discussion especially fun! Remember that the models you will read about are just that – models. They aren't prescribed cure-alls for developers, just some of the best ideas we currently have on what has worked in the past and why they will likely continue to work. None of these ideas are without flaws, so go find interesting (and educated) opinions on them to bring to the discussion.

Required

- 1) Software Engineering, Ch.25, Intro – Section 25.1 (10 pages)
- 2) [SemVer](#), (Summary, Introduction, Specification, Why Use SemVer)
- 3) [Git-Flow](#)
- 4) [Trunk-Based Development](#)

Recommended

There are other branching strategies besides those selected as required readings, so see what else you can find! You might also consider looking around for well known software that was built using these strategies. Finally, if you've made it this far in your degree without learning basic Git/GitHub commands, this is a good time to read up on the basics. It may or may not come up during the discussion, but it will certainly be useful for Part 3 of this course.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain what version control is, and list its key features
- Define configuration management and differentiate it from version control
- Discuss the use of semantic versioning in software projects, giving at least one example of a project that would (or would not) benefit from its adoption
- Explain the workings of 2-3 version control branching strategies, contrasting the strengths and weaknesses of each